EXPERIMENT 07

Creating Custom Forms, Fields, and Relationships in Zoho Creator

Library Book Issue Request Form (Form Design & Data Modeling Use Case)

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1. Aim

To design and construct custom application forms, configure diverse field types (single line, email, date, drop-down, lookup fields), and establish parent-child and relational data models within a Zoho Creator application (Library Book Issue Request Form).

The experiment covers form creation, field attribute configuration, mandatory field validations, lookup relationships, and subform structuring.

2. Procedure

Step 1: Initialize application and form builder. Created a new application workspace in Zoho Creator and added a primary form titled 'Library Book Issue Request'.

Step 2: Add basic and advanced fields. Configured fields including Student Name (Single Line), Roll Number (Single Line with validation), Email Address (Email field type), and Department (Drop-down).

Step 3: Establish lookup relationships. Created a relational lookup field linking the book request form to the master 'Book Catalog' form to dynamically fetch book titles and availability status.

Step 4: Configure date and status fields. Added Date fields for Issue Date and Expected Return Date, along with a Choice field for Approval Status.

Step 5: Set field validation properties. Marked critical fields as mandatory and established unique constraints on student roll numbers to prevent duplicate submission errors.

Note: This is a structured form design exercise. Field attributes and validation rules follow standard Zoho Creator data modeling guidelines.

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3. Output

3.1 Form Field Architecture & Data Types

The form schema structure for the Library Book Issue Request application is outlined below:

Field Label	Field Type	Mandatory / Unique	Description
Student Name	Single Line	Mandatory	Stores full name of the requesting student.
Roll Number	Single Line	Mandatory & Unique	Student identification number (e.g., 241401076).
Email Address	Email	Mandatory	Used for sending automated approval notifications.
Book Title	Lookup Field	Mandatory	Relational link fetching books from Book Catalog.
Issue Date	Date	Mandatory	Records the date when the book is issued.
Return Date	Date	Mandatory	Records the expected book return deadline.
Approval Status	Drop-down	Mandatory	Tracks request state (Pending, Approved, Rejected).

3.2 Relational Data Modeling & Lookup Configuration

By establishing a lookup relationship between the Book Issue form and the Book Catalog form, data redundancy is eliminated. Whenever a book title is updated in the master catalog, the change automatically reflects across all linked issue requests.

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3.3 User Interface Layout & Form Usability

Form sections were organized into logical containers ('Student Details', 'Book Selection', and 'Rental Schedule') to enhance user experience. Conditional visibility rules were applied to hide or display fine collection fields only when a book is marked as returned past its due date.

4. Final Result

Successfully designed and constructed custom application forms, configured diverse field types, and established robust lookup relationships for the Library Book Issue Request Form application in Zoho Creator.

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